

tions as is, whatever is. So, don't go for professionally-shot videos, rather, personalise them. As Praytell's creative strategy producer, Kat Lapelosa puts it, "Users aren't interested in shiny, highly produced content." So forget about pictures or videos that are taken painstakingly, elevating celebrities to demi-God status. Lights, camera, action has been taken over by Phone, TikTok, Action. It's all about exaggerations and being eccentric and not about possessing a carefully crafted image.

16. Another example is #faketravel which clocked more than 14 million views. It was all about showing off how you are travelling but from your own home. This was about faking travel! Users showed off videos of themselves sitting on a plane or with their suitcases while sitting in the comforts of their homes or even posing in their backyards. And it came at a time when other apps were making travel goals, and people were feeling low or envious seeing others travelling.
17. You might think that premium, luxury brands shun TikTok perceiving it to be "downmarket". Think again! In July this year, BMW used TikTok's hashtag challenge for its new 1 Series in #THE1 Challenge. BMW asked influencers like Sky&Tami, PatroX and Falco Punch to show off their unique moves dancing in, on and around the new cars. Over 7 million views guaranteed its success. The demographic profile may not agree to a platform like TikTok, especially since the brand image of BMW is the polar opposite of the app. However, BMW broke the stereotypes and thought ahead by engaging with their future audience or new users. These are the users who influence buyers and voice their preferences. Moreover, it is important to connect with users who decide the fashion trends. A lesson in relevance well-executed and well-thought by a premium car company.

Not just BMW, the renowned fashion brand Ralph Lauren was also not far behind when it came to cashing in on the TikTok wave. Ralph Lauren was a bit different in the sense that it used the "hashtag challenge plus" instead of a "hashtag". In "hashtag challenge plus" the TikTok users can be directed to a Ralph Lauren store and also buy products within the app. An interactive and innovative way to connect with new and existing target consumers, #WinningRL campaign used influencer Diana Silvers.

Commemorating the US Open's beginning, Ralph Lauren asked users to share the time when they won a real-life challenge. The prize was of receiving official Polo Ralph Lauren US Open apparel since the brand is the official outfitter of the tennis event. So you see, the discerning few have jumped